

Quick and Handy Grammar Review

Prepositions have many uses in English. For example, they can express time (*in 2012, at 7:00, during the meeting*), place (*on the chair, at a restaurant, behind the sofa*), direction (*to the store, from Japan*), method (*by mail, with a fork*), material (*of wood, with cotton*), etc. Let's take a look at some common prepositions in English, and then we'll practise using them.

A. Common Prepositions

The following is a list of common prepositions, some notes on their use, and examples.

Preposition	Meaning(s)	Examples
about	on (the subject of), around (a place)	- I read a book about the war. - The speech was about causes of cancer. - You can now move freely about the cabin.
above	on top of	- I placed the painting above the table. - The blue sky was above us all afternoon.
across (from)	on the other side	- The theatre is across from the bank. - Columbus travelled across the ocean in 1492.
after	later in time	After the game, the players went to dinner. After lunch, I studied in the library. - The students were very tired after the exam.
against	opposed to, in contact with	- Mr. Jones ran against Ms. Adams for treasurer. - The umbrella is leaning against the wall.
along	on the side of	- We strolled along the bank of the river. - There are many hotels along the Danube.
among	in the midst of	- There is a cat sitting among the flowers. - He was found among the dead after the battle.
around	in a circle, turning a corner	- The teacher walked around the room. - Ken lives around the block.
at	clock time, place	- The game starts at 9:00. - Leslie works at Apple Computers. - I'll meet you at the restaurant.